



AFTER

The Civil War would have a large impact on the art of fortification, but there were many lessons still to be learned about siege warfare.

A NEW ERA IN FORTIFICATION

The **range, power, and accuracy** of rifled artillery had **ended the era** of stone and masonry forts, often pulverizing them while strongholds of packed earth and sand withstood bombardment much better. Still, coastal forts were **rarely taken by naval guns** alone; joint operations between land and sea forces would in the future become the norm.

REPERCUSSIONS

European observers, impressed by the **deadly accuracy** of rifled guns and their increased rates of fire, returned home with new ideas on how better to construct fortifications that might **withstand modern sieges**. The maze of **muddy trenches**, forts, and bombproofs at Petersburg proved to be an omen of the appalling conditions on the **Western Front (1914–18)**.